



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*śuddhasphuraṇarūpasya dṛśyabhāvamapaśyataḥ |
kva vidhiḥ kva ca vairāgyaṃ kva tyāgaḥ kva śama+api vā | | 18 | 71 | |
sphurato+anantarūpeṇa prakṛtiṃ ca na paśyataḥ |
kva bandhaḥ kva ca vā mokṣaḥ kva harṣaḥ kva viṣādatā | | 18 | 72 | |*

— Aṣṭāvakragītā, Prakaraṇa 18 (Chapter 18), Verses 71-72

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

When you perceive the Self as pure, radiant consciousness, the very notion of the visible world as something separate begins to dissolve. Where is there room for rules and rituals (vidhi), or even renunciation (vairāgya) and detachment (tyāga), or even tranquility (śama), when all that remains is the shimmering, undivided light of awareness?

Similarly, when you recognize the infinite, unbounded nature of your being, and cease to identify with the illusion of separate existence, the "prakṛti", or nature, is no longer seen as a binding force. Where is there bondage (bandha) or liberation (mokṣa)? Where is there joy (harṣa) or sorrow (viṣādatā)? These are all concepts born from the limited perspective of the ego, which imagines itself to be a distinct entity caught in the web of cause and effect.

In essence, Aṣṭāvakra is guiding you beyond the duality that fuels suffering. It's an invitation to see through the illusion of a world composed of separate objects and experiences. This wisdom can be applied to modern life by challenging your ingrained beliefs about who you are and what truly matters. Are you constantly striving for something "better," caught in an endless cycle of desire and dissatisfaction? This passage suggests that the freedom you seek isn't found in acquiring or achieving, but in recognizing the inherent perfection of your own being. Let go of the need to control, to judge, to label. Simply be. Embrace the radiant consciousness that you are, and watch as the limitations of the perceived world begin to fade away. This isn't about denying the world, but about seeing it with new eyes, understanding its impermanence, and recognizing your own eternal nature.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

If you truly saw yourself as pure consciousness, how would that change the way you approach the challenges and joys of your day?